March 2026

The Honorable Tim Scott
717 Hart Senate Office Building
Washington, DC 20510
Phone: (202) 224-6121

Dear Senator Scott,

Your career has been built on a foundational conviction: that opportunity is not given, it is cultivated — through work, through service, and through institutions that give young people the chance to discover what they are capable of. That conviction is precisely why I am writing to you about the National Experiential Civic Education Framework.

NECEF proposes embedding structured, hands-on civic programs in schools nationwide — community service, emergency preparedness, infrastructure stewardship, and leadership development. This is not a government program that does things for young people. It is a framework that asks young people to do things for their communities. The distinction matters enormously, and you understand it better than most.

The historical case is grounded in exactly the tradition you have championed: the Founders understood that republican self-government required citizens who practiced citizenship — not passive recipients of government services, but active participants in the life of their communities. Tocqueville called this the engine of American democratic vitality. Putnam's research proved its absence is a democratic liability. NECEF is the structural response.

The framework is bipartisan by design. Emergency preparedness, community service, and leadership development are not partisan positions. State and local communities define their own program content. Federal dollars flow through existing AmeriCorps and Title IV mechanisms — no new bureaucracy.

I am asking you to consider co-sponsoring this framework and lending your voice to its national launch. Your endorsement would signal to conservative America that this is about citizenship and responsibility — not government expansion. That signal is essential to building the bipartisan coalition this effort requires.

I would welcome the opportunity to brief you and your staff at your convenience. The full white paper is enclosed.

With respect and admiration,

Gina Aulabaugh